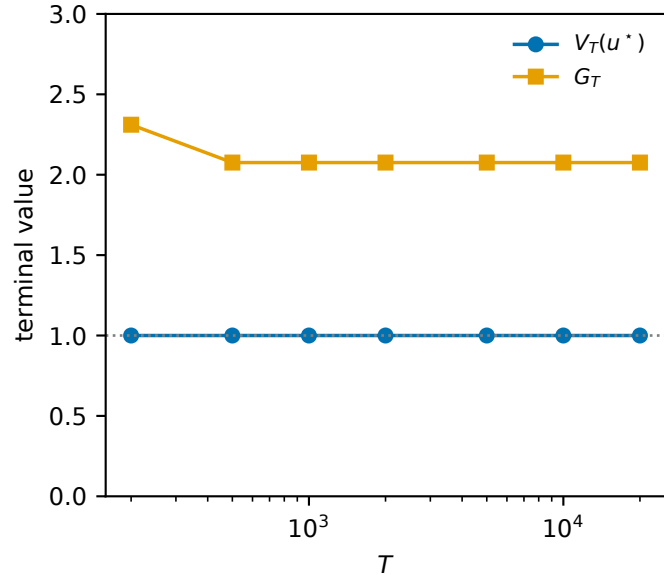
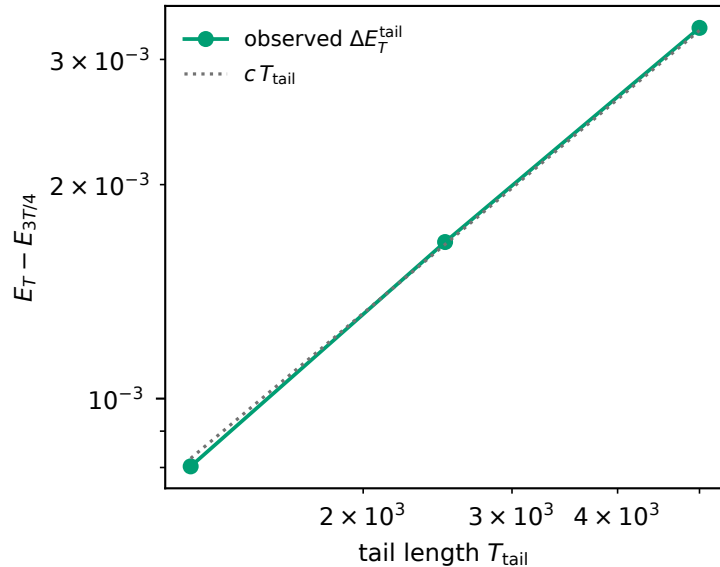
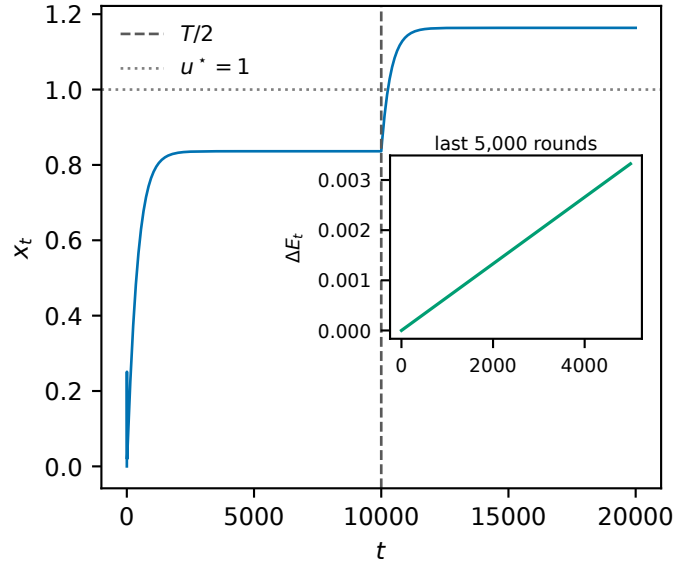


Exact $V_T(u^*) = 1$; bounded G_T 

Linear settled-tail contribution

Two settled regimes, $T = 2 \times 10^4$ 

Raw E_T is transient-dominated for $T \leq 2 \times 10^4$; the plotted tail is a mechanism diagnostic, not a certificate.